

Assignment 4

Experience Report (optional)

If you participated in one of the work integrated learning experiences, in lieu of this assignment, you can submit a 500 word experience report on what you did, who you worked with, and what you learned that relates to the topics in this course.

1. Information Presentation Response

Choose one of the information presentation videos and respond to the following prompt in 2-3 sentences:

- Given the prompt that the presenter was given (you can see all of the prompts as pdfs linked on the schedule), did the video accurately and completely fulfill the information need? Did the presentation match what was asked in the prompt? Did all of the elements of the prompt get covered in the video?

2. Cultural Issues in Computer Science Education

In her paper titled “*When Twice as Good Isn’t Enough: The Case for Cultural Competence in Computing*”, Nicki Washington discusses the need for “cultural competence as a required focus for university computing departments”. Read the article, and respond to it in 250-500 words. Does the article resonate with your experience? Do you think this is a good idea? Should UTSC institute the practices called for? You can base this on a combination of the data presented, what you’ve learned in this course, and your own personal experience. But you will need to go beyond simply saying “I agree” or “I disagree” and use data and examples to support your stance.

3. Criticize an argument

Write a 500-750 word response to one of the following prompts:

Pick a topic from a presentation in which you were not involved. Take an argument made by the individual/group, and refute it as thoroughly as you can. Start with the references included on the presentation slides: Do they live up to the CRAAP assessment we learned about at the beginning of the course? Then move onto the argument itself: Do the facts really justify what they're being used to justify? Did the presenter(s) miss anything? Or did they misinterpret/misrepresent some of the data?

Note that this is not an opportunity for ad hominem attacks. You're not criticizing the presentations of the presenters, you're criticizing their research and their argument. Pretend that they will be reading this (they won't, don't worry) after you've submitted it, and be ready to defend their position, so you have to really try to make your criticisms as logical and research based as you possibly can.

or

Pick something you believed before the course began/earlier in the course that you no longer believe. Explain why your mind was changed. What data did you find convincing? What arguments were persuasive to you? This isn't as simple as just saying "I used to think X and now I think Y.", you need to explain why you used to think X, what arguments/data you used to believe supported X that you no longer believe/find persuasive, and explain what it was that made you change your mind.